

Diagnostic Card

Feed Archaeology · Algorithms That Choose Us · [Anonymized Institution]
PHASE 3 — INVESTIGATION

How to use this card

Fill it out progressively during Phases 3.1 to 3.4. Complete the corresponding section for each subphase. By the end, your feed analysis must be explicitly connected to Mariana's case.

A. What dominates my feed?

Phase 3.1 — The Mirror

- Which themes appear most frequently? Which voices/profiles dominate?
- Which theme is absent from my feed? → In Mariana's feed, what was absent?

B. The shock of a peer's feed

Phase 3.2 — Device Swap

- Three differences I noticed between my feed and my peer's feed:
- If my peer's feed had been Mariana's feed for 2 years, would she have reached the same conclusion in the report? Why?

C. Naming what I saw

Phase 3.3 — Pattern Map

Which bias category best explains what I found AND what happened to Mariana?

- ☐ **Data bias** — the algorithm was trained on data that reflects historical patterns.
- ☐ **Design bias** — system choices favor certain profiles by project design.
- ☐ **Feedback bias** — the algorithm learns and amplifies what the user has already seen.
- ☐ **All three acting together** — describe below how each one operated.

Explicit connection to Mariana: is it the same mechanism that operated in her case?

Diagnostic Card — Back Page

Assessment Rubric · Phase 3.4 + Synthesis

D. What if I were Mariana's engineer?

Phase 3.4

The 3 concrete changes I would recommend to the job recommendation system of the startup:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

How did Mariana come to believe that algorithms were neutral? Which feed mechanism was responsible?

Assessment Rubric — Diagnostic Card

This rubric is presented before Phase 3. The instructor evaluates the card at the end of the short course.

Assessment Criteria	Needs Improvement	Developing	Proficient
Bias Identification	Does not name the category or confuses the types of bias.	Correctly names at least 1 bias category with an example from their own feed.	Names and distinguishes the 3 categories; explains how each operated in their own feed and in Mariana's.
Connection to the Case	Does not establish a relationship between their own feed and Mariana's case.	Makes at least 1 explicit connection between the feed mechanism and Mariana's case.	Demonstrates that the feed mechanism and the job system mechanism are instances of the same phenomenon.
Systematically Absent Content	Does not identify any absence or lists something generic.	Describes 1 absent content from their own feed with an explanation of why.	Relates the absence to a design choice or algorithmic feedback loop.
Technical Recommendation	Vague recommendation or without technical foundation.	Proposes 1 concrete technical change with minimal justification.	Proposes 3 articulated changes, with a technical foundation and explicit ethical dimension.

Note: The "Developing" level is a legitimate achievement — it indicates that the student investigated and identified gaps.

Two-Voice Letter

Synthesis and Transfer Instrument · Algorithms That Choose Us · [Anonymized Institution]
PHASE 4 — SYNTHESIS

You have 25 minutes. Write individually, without consulting peers or materials. There is no minimum or maximum length — an honest paragraph is worth more than two generic paragraphs. Those who struggle with writing may record an audio clip of up to 2 minutes for each voice.

VOICE 1: To Mariana

Remember that you investigated your own feed today. You saw, with your own eyes, the mechanism that operated on Mariana. Write to her as someone who understands what happened — not as someone judging her.

"Mariana, if I were your teammate, I would tell you that..."

Content Guides (at least 1 of each):

- **Specific technical recommendation:** What should she do now regarding the job recommendation system? Based on what technical foundation?
- **Ethical foundation:** Why does this change matter beyond the technical scope? Who is affected?

VOICE 2: To Myself

You are not just an observer of what happened to Mariana. You investigated your own feed today. What will you do differently from now on?

"Now that I know what I know, I will..."

Concrete Personal Actions (minimum of 2, specific and applicable starting today):

Saying "I will use my phone less" is not valid. Valid example: "Once a week, I will actively search for a topic that never appears in my feed."

"...and when I build systems, I commit to..."

Professional Ethical Principle (1 explicit principle for your future practice):

- Express an understanding that technical choices have social consequences.

What the Instructor Evaluates in This Letter

Criteria	Needs Improvement	Developing	Proficient
Recommendation to Mariana	Generic, without technical or ethical foundation.	Specific, with minimal technical or ethical justification.	Specific, with articulated technical AND ethical foundations.
Personal Actions	Vague ("I will use less") or unfeasible.	2 concrete actions applicable starting today.	2+ actions with a monitoring mechanism or personal evaluation criteria.
Professional Principle	Abstract or disconnected from practice.	Expresses that technical choices have social consequences.	Connects the principle to a specific technical decision they will make.

This letter is not graded. The instructor provides individualized written feedback within 7 days, always quoting a specific excerpt from the student's work.